Easy to make from kitchen pantry ingredients, using canned tomatoes, this delicious soup can be enjoyed all year round to brighten the dullest day.

classic tomato soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 55 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1 tbsp olive oil
1 onion, chopped
1 garlic clove, sliced
2 celery ribs, sliced
1 carrot, sliced
1 potato, chopped
2 x 14oz (400g) cans tomatoes
3¼ cups vegetable or chicken stock
1 bay leaf
1 tsp sugar
salt and pepper

1 Heat the oil in a large saucepan over medium-low heat, add the onion, garlic, and celery and cook, stirring frequently, until softened but not colored.

2 Add the carrot and potato and stir for 1 minute, then add the tomatoes with their juices, the stock, bay leaf, and sugar. Season to taste, bring to a boil, then reduce the heat, cover, and simmer for 45 minutes, or until the vegetables are very soft.

3 Remove from the heat and let cool slightly, then process in a blender or food processor until smooth, working in batches if necessary. Taste and adjust the seasoning, then reheat and serve.